

Market Intelligence Agent Project

Saudi Rental Housing

By Raghad Almutairi

Step 1: Select a dataset on Kaggle and download it

My dataset: https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/lama122/saudi-arabia-real-estate-aqar?select=SA_Aqar.csv

SA_Aqar.csv (1.56 MB)

Detail

Compact

Column

10 of 24 columns

About this file

Suggest Edits

The data contains 3799 rows and 24 columns.

city	district	front	size	property_age	bedrooms
city where house locate in	district where house locate in	What is the house front is north, west .. etc	size in m*2	property age for the house	number of bedrooms
الخبر	حي ضلعوة الملك فهد	شمال	250	0	5
الرياض	حي النازع	شرق	370	0	4
Other (1782)	Other (3396)	Other (2025)	380	0	4
الرياض	حي النخلة	غرب	250	0	5
الرياض	حي النخلة	غرب	400	11	7
الرياض	حي الزاهر	شرق	250	25	5
الرياض	حي النخلة	شمال	250	0	5
الرياض	حي النخلة	شمال	250	0	5

Data Explorer

1.56 MB

SA_Aqar.csv

Summary

1 file

24 columns

Amazon Quick

Datasets

Saudi Arabia Real Estate.csv

UdacityQuicksightLab

< Datasets

Saudi Arabia Real Estate.csv

Generate analysis

Chat

Edit dataset

Summary

Refresh

Permissions

Usage

Columns (24)

Search

Name	Type	Description
city	String	
district	String	
front	String	
size	Integer	
property_age	Integer	
bedrooms	Integer	
bathrooms	Integer	
livingrooms	Integer	
kitchen	Integer	
garage	Integer	
driver_room	Integer	
maid_room	Integer	

About

SPICE

Size: 2.5 MB

Refresh

Completed

3718 rows imported (100% success)

Last refresh at October 5, 2026 at 9:20 AM GMT+3

Access

Row-level security

Set up

Column-level security

Set up

Sources

Saudi Arabia Real Estate.csv

Usage

Step 2: Upload your dataset to space

Amazon Quick

Spaces > Market Intelligence – Saudi Rental Ho...

< All spaces

Success

Successfully added 1 resource to space.

Market Intelligence – Saudi Rental Ho...

Share

Produce a leadership-ready market intelligence package on Saudi residential rental housing (Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam, Al-Khobar). Business question: which city should a residential rental investor evaluate first for new rental housing, based on rental price patterns and current market signals? Internal data: Kaggle AQAR rental listings dataset (about 3,700 listings, scraped in 2021). External data: Quick Research on current market conditions. Deliverables: Quick Research outputs, Market Analysis, Market Intelligence Brief, and a reliability/confidence evaluation.

Q Search by name...

All

+ Add

Suggested for you

NovaTech Revenue...ith annotations +

NovaTech Revenue...gence Dashboard +

C2.1_Interactiv...RaghadAlmutairi +

C2.1_Operations...RaghadAlmutairi +

Name	Status	Added on	Added by	Actions
 Saudi Arabia Real Estate.csv	✓ Ready	4 minutes ago	VocFirst16237011 VocLast16237011	

Step 3: Create the Market Intelligence Agent

“You are a Market Intelligence Agent. Your job is to analyze a dataset and external market signals to produce a market analysis and a leadership-ready brief.

I want a chat agent that helps business leaders and investors decide which Saudi city (Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam, or Al-Khobar) to evaluate first for new residential rental housing. It should use the internal knowledge base: a Kaggle dataset of about 3,700 Saudi rental listings scraped from Aqar in 2021 (columns: city, district, size, property age, bedrooms, amenities, and annual rent in SAR). It should also use external research outputs from Quick Research that I provide.

Capabilities: produce a Market Analysis (competitive landscape summary, key trends and signals, opportunities and risks, evidence from both dataset and external research); produce a Market Intelligence Brief (objective and scope, 3 to 5 key insights, why each matters, confidence and limitations, strategic implications and next steps); and run a reliability check for each insight (evidence, gaps and assumptions, confidence level High/Medium/Low, and what cannot be concluded).

Rules: use medians rather than averages because the data has outliers; label every claim as DATASET or EXTERNAL RESEARCH; state that the data is from 2021 whenever it affects a conclusion; never invent figures and say so when evidence is missing; do not draw investment yield or ROI conclusions because the dataset has rents only and no purchase prices.

The tone should be professional, concise, and decision-oriented, written for senior leadership.”

Amazon Quick

Chat agents

>

New chat agent

UdacityQuicksightLab



Build chat agents with unique personas and capabilities

Tell us your goals or start with a [template](#)

You are a **Market Intelligence Agent**. Your job is to analyze a dataset and external market signals to produce a market analysis and a leadership-ready brief.

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Clear

Character count 1565/50000

Skip

Generate

Looking for inspiration? Check out some of our sample chat agent creation instructions below.

 **Training Guide**
“Create an agent that helps new team members learn about our processes and tools. Should answer common questio...”

 **Project Coordinator**
“Build an agent that helps track project status, find relevant documentation, and assist with common project tasks. Sho...”

 **Onboarding Helper**
“Create an agent that guides people through setup and access requests. Should help with common system acce...”

Name:

Market Intelligence Agent – Saudi Rental Housing

Agent purpose / description:

You are a Market Intelligence Agent. Your job is to analyze a dataset and external market signals to produce a market analysis and a leadership-ready brief.

The screenshot displays the Amazon Quick Chat Agents interface for a custom agent named "Market Intelligence Agent – Saudi Rental Housing". The interface is divided into two main sections: a configuration panel on the left and a chat preview on the right.

Configuration Panel (Left):

- Header:** "Market Intelligence Agent – Saudi Rental Housing" with a "Share" button and a "Launch chat agent" button.
- Agent Persona:** A section titled "Configure chat agent" with a "Update preview" button. It includes a "Your chat agent comes equipped with enterprise guardrails." message.
- Instructions:** A text area containing detailed instructions for the agent's role, including analyzing Saudi residential rental housing data, producing objective evidence-based market intelligence, and following specific operational rules (1-8). A "Refine" button is at the bottom.
- Reference documents:** A section titled "Reference documents" with a note about attaching templates, workflows, and examples. It includes an "Upload Files" button and a note about file formats and size limits.
- Knowledge Sources (1):** A section titled "KNOWLEDGE SOURCES (1)" with a "Create" button and a "Link spaces" button. It shows a single source: "Market Intelligence – Saudi Rental Housing".
- Actions (0):** A section titled "ACTIONS (0)" with a "Create" button and a "Link actions" button.

Chat Preview (Right):

- Header:** "You are previewing Market Intelligence Agent."
- Agent Card:** A card titled "Market Intelligence Agent" with a "Preview" button. It includes a "Ask a question..." input field and a "Smart" dropdown menu.
- Example Questions:** Two example questions are listed: "Compare rental price medians across Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam, and..." and "Produce a Market Intelligence Brief with key insights and strategic L...".
- Footer:** A note stating "Usage is subject to AWS Responsible AI Policy".

Agent test query

What is the median annual rent by city in the dataset?

MARKET INTELLIGENCE AGENT Completed 1 step

Here are the median annual rents by city from the dataset:

City	Listings	Median Annual Rent (SAR)
Jeddah (جدة)	888	95,000
Riyadh (الرياض)	960	80,000
Al-Khobar (الخبر)	976	75,000
Dammam (الدمام)	894	60,000

[View more](#)

Key Takeaways (DATASET — 2021 AQAR Listings)

- **Jeddah leads** with the highest median annual rent at **SAR 95,000**, roughly 58% above Dammam, the lowest-priced city.
[Saudi Arabia Real...](#)
- **Riyadh and Al-Khobar** sit in the middle tier at SAR 80,000 and SAR 75,000 respectively — within ~7% of each other.
[Saudi Arabia Real...](#)
- **Dammam** is the most affordable market at **SAR 60,000** median annual rent. [Saudi Arabia Real...](#)
- Medians were used (per operating guidance) to mitigate the influence of outliers in the data.

Caveats

- This data is from the **2021 AQAR listings dataset** and may not reflect current market conditions.
- The dataset does not explicitly specify rent frequency, but the magnitudes align with **annual rent in SAR** per typical AQAR listing conventions.

What would you like to explore next?

The agent correctly returned median annual rent by city from the dataset (Jeddah highest at 95,000 SAR, Dammam lowest at 60,000 SAR) and flagged the 2021 data date as a limitation. **Conclusion:** The agent works as intended, and Jeddah is an early leader that still needs external validation.

Amazon Quick

New chat

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Campaign Source Per

Support Ticket Priority Analysis

Executive Performance and Ch

UdacityQuicksightLab

Expand

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Market Intelligence Agent – Saudi Rental Housing

Copy link

Description

You are a Market Intelligence Agent. Your job is to analyze a dataset and external market signals to produce a market analysis and a leadership-ready brief.

Instructions summary

Serve as a rigorous market intelligence analyst who delivers objective, evidence-based insights on Saudi residential rental markets with executive-level precision and methodical data attribution.

Created by

VocFirst16237011 VocLast16237011

Last modified

10/5/2026, 9:55:02 AM

Capabilities

Ask questions about your data, analyze trends, explore topics, or access information from your spaces. You can also add action connectors to take actions based on your data.

Knowledge

Actions

Name	Description	Last modified
 Market Intelligence – Saudi Rental Ho...	Produce a leadership-rea...	34 minutes ago

Items per page 25 < 1 >

Edit

Chat

Step 4: Run Quick Research to gather external market signals

Research the current state of the Saudi residential rental market in Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam, and Al-Khobar for 2025-2026, to help a residential rental investor decide which city to evaluate first. Cover: (1) recent rental price trends and rent growth by city, (2) housing supply and demand drivers such as population growth, major projects, and Vision 2030 housing programs, (3) vacancy or occupancy signals, and (4) major competitors or institutional players in residential rental housing. Use web research to supplement an internal 2021 rental listings dataset, focusing on current conditions the dataset cannot show. Cite every source with its publication date and flag any conflicting figures between sources.

New research

Research objective

Research the current state of the Saudi residential rental market in Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam, and Al-Khobar for 2025-2026, to help a residential rental investor decide which city to evaluate first. Cover: (1) recent rental price trends and rent growth by city, (2) housing supply and demand drivers such as population growth, major projects, and Vision 2030 housing programs, (3) vacancy or occupancy signals, and (4) major competitors or institutional players in residential rental housing. Use web research to supplement an internal 2021 rental listings dataset, focusing on current conditions the dataset cannot show. Cite every source with its publication date and flag any conflicting figures between sources.

14287 characters remaining Research mode: Fast

Research materials

☒ **Web search** ⓘ ⌵

Specify which websites or types of websites the agent should prioritize or avoid

Preferred websites (Optional)

startis.gov.sa, rega.gov.sa, momah.gov.sa, knightfrank.com, jll.com, cbre.com, colliers.com, savills.com

Websites to avoid (Optional)

social media, forums, blogs

☒ **File uploads** Upload

Pro tip: Working with larger collections? Spaces helps you organize and optimize extensive research materials. Dismiss

Review plan Start researching

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The quick and easy way to get quality research done fast.

You're in control - I'll follow your expertise and guidance throughout our collaboration.

Set up the Research Document

Share your research objective in a few sentences to describe your goal, frameworks, desired outcomes and any other essential information including your industry context and any specific requirements or constraints.

Example

Evaluate renewable energy investment opportunities for our corporate sustainability portfolio to support Q1 2025 capital allocation decisions. We're allocating \$50M across North American markets with a 7-year investment horizon. Focus on solar, wind, and battery storage sectors from 2023-2024 performance data. Key metrics: IRR projections, regulatory incentive impacts, market growth trends, and risk-adjusted returns. Cost sensitivity is critical - prioritize solutions under \$2M per MW capacity.

Primarily build research on our internal investment analysis from Document: "Renewable_Portfolio_Performance_2024.pdf" in Knowledge base: "Investment Research", which is added in Space: "Financial Analysis", and Chart: "Investment Performance Trends" in Dashboard: "Sustainability Portfolio Dashboard". Use web research to supplement with recent policy changes, emerging technology costs, and competitor strategies not covered in our internal data.

Next, select upload any helpful documents, and select Quick assets as called out in the research objective to generate a plan.

[▶ Start researching](#)

Amazon Quick Research > Saudi Arabia Residential Rental Market Analysis 2025-2026: City Comparison for Investment Priority UdacityQuicksightLab

[▶ Start researching](#)

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▶ Start researching

Amazon QuickResearch

Saudi Arabia Residential Rental Market Analysis 2025-2026: City Comparison for Investment Priority

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Start researching

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Research materials

Web search

Preferred websites

stats.gov.sa, rega.gov.sa, momah.gov.sa, knightfrank.com, jll.com, cbre.com, colliers.com, savills.com

Websites to avoid

social media, forums, blogs

File uploads

No files uploaded

Quick assets

Pro tip: For optimal results, consider

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Share feedback

Topics to explore

1. Rental Price Trends and Growth Rates by City

Analyze year-over-year and quarterly rental price movements for family residential rentals (villas, houses, floors, apartments combined) across Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam, and Al-Khobar from 2025-2026. Compare growth rates against the internal 2021 dataset baseline (Jeddah 95,000 SAR, Riyadh 80,000 SAR, Al-Khobar 75,000 SAR, Dammam 60,000 SAR annual rent) to identify acceleration or deceleration patterns. Flag any conflicting figures between sources and identify rent freeze policies or regulatory interventions affecting pricing.

2. Population Growth and Demographic Drivers

Examine population growth rates, expatriate influx, and demographic shifts in each city that drive rental demand. Assess how Vision 2030 initiatives and economic diversification are attracting residents and workers to specific urban centers between 2025-2026.

3. Housing Supply Dynamics and Major Development Projects

Identify major residential development projects, new housing completions, and pipeline supply in each city. Evaluate Vision 2030 housing programs, Sakani initiatives, and private sector projects that impact family residential rental supply availability and affordability in 2025-2026, comparing overall rental supply without splitting by property type unless sources differentiate.

4. Vacancy and Occupancy Rates

Assess current vacancy rates, occupancy signals, and market absorption rates across the four cities. Analyze Ejar platform data and rental contract registrations to gauge market tightness and identify supply-demand imbalances in 2025-2026, drawing from external sources since the internal 2021 dataset contains no occupancy or vacancy data.

5. Institutional Players and Competitive Landscape

Profile major institutional investors and built-to-rent operators in each city, evaluating market concentration, competitive positioning, and barriers to entry for new rental investors in 2025-2026. Briefly mention individual landlords and property management companies as a segment within the broader competitive landscape.

6. Regulatory Environment and Policy Support

Review rental market regulations, tenant protections, landlord incentives, and government support mechanisms including Vision 2030 housing programs. Assess how policy changes between 2021 and 2026 affect rental market attractiveness and investor returns.

Research

Hello! The research plan is ready. Here are a few key clarifications—if you can answer them, it'll help me refine the plan even further.

Key clarification:

- Should the analysis prioritize affordability-focused family rentals or include luxury compounds and high-end segments?
- Confirm whether Ejar platform data and rental contract registrations are available in your Space for 2025-2026 occupancy analysis.
- Define investment decision criteria: which city metrics (price growth, occupancy, supply pipeline, institutional presence) matter most for your evaluation priority?

What can I do to make it better?

Revised plan

Revision history

Amazon QuickResearch

Saudi Arabia Residential Rental Market Analysis 2025-2026: City Comparison for Investment Priority

UdacityQuicksightLab

Saudi Arabia Residential Rental Market Analysis 2025-2026: City Comparison for Investment Priority

Version 1

Share

Summarize

Research

Research the current state of the Saudi residential rental market in Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam, and Al-Khobar for 2025-2026, to help a residential rental investor decide which city to evaluate fir...

MaterialsTopics

Research materials

Web search

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Share feedback

Rate report: ☆☆☆☆☆

Saudi Arabia Residential Rental Market Analysis 2025–2026: City Comparison for Investment Priority

Executive Summary

For a residential rental investor evaluating Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam, and Al-Khobar, the analysis points to **Dammam/Al-Khobar as the strongest first-evaluation market**, followed by Jeddah, with Riyadh—despite having the most powerful demand fundamentals—ranking third due to a critical regulatory constraint. Since the internal 2021 dataset was compiled, the market has been reshaped by Vision 2030–driven urbanization, a new foreign ownership law effective January 2026^{1,2}, mandatory digital lease registration via Ejar³, and most consequentially, a five-year rent freeze imposed on Riyadh in September 2025⁴ that caps landlord income growth through 2030.

Dammam and Al-Khobar offer the most favorable risk-adjusted profile: steady 2–3% annual rent growth⁵, no rent freeze, unrestricted foreign ownership², competitive pricing attracting spillover demand from Riyadh, and a fragmented competitive landscape with low institutional concentration—leaving more room for mid-scale investors. Jeddah ranks second, benefiting from a \$431.3 billion western giga-project pipeline driving long-term employment growth⁶ and moderate positive rent trends, though its larger supply pipeline introduces absorption risk. Riyadh delivers the strongest demand signals—apartment rents rose 10.3% year-over-year in H1 2025⁷ and Ejar contract values surged 85% in Q1 2026⁸—but the rent freeze, intense competition from PIF-backed developers like ROSHN⁹, and the highest entry costs significantly constrain near-term income upside. Notably, Saudi Arabia's built-to-rent sector remains nascent at approximately \$0.33 billion¹⁰, suggesting that early institutional entrants in less contested markets stand to benefit disproportionately as the sector matures.

Comments

Research

Here's how you can make this research even better:

- Highlight any text to add specific comments (like exploring a claim further or requesting more evidence)
- Add overall comment in this panel (new angles to explore or additional context to consider)
- When you're ready, create the next version. I'll update the report based on all your comments.

Add a comment

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Quick assets

Pro tip: For optimal

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Rental Price Trends and Growth by City

Riyadh: From Surge to Stabilization. Riyadh posted the strongest rental growth among the four cities in H1 2025, with apartment rents rising 10.3% year-over-year and villa rents surging 14.4% ⁷. However, this trajectory reversed sharply following the government's September 2025 rent freeze, which prohibits any rental increases within Riyadh's urban boundaries for five years ⁴. By Q1 2026, quarterly rents had declined 2.8% for apartments and 1.2% for villas, though year-over-year figures remained positive at approximately 6% and 5% respectively ⁵. The residential sector across all major cities is transitioning from speculative price growth to more stable, demand-driven dynamics ¹³.

Jeddah: Moderate and Bifurcated. Jeddah's rental market showed a clear split between segments. Apartment rents grew 4.7% year-over-year in H1 2025, while villa rents actually declined 2.7% over the same period ⁷. By Q1 2026, apartment rents remained 2.7% higher year-over-year and villa rents were up nearly 1% ⁵, suggesting a gradual stabilization. The villa softness likely reflects affordability pressures pushing demand toward smaller units.

Dammam and Al-Khobar: Steady and Consistent. The Eastern Province cities delivered the most consistent performance. In Q1 2026, Dammam apartment rents increased 3.2% annually while villa rents rose 2.1% ⁵. Sales values in the Dammam Metropolitan Area climbed approximately 30% year-over-year, with competitive pricing attracting demand spillover from Riyadh's more expensive market.

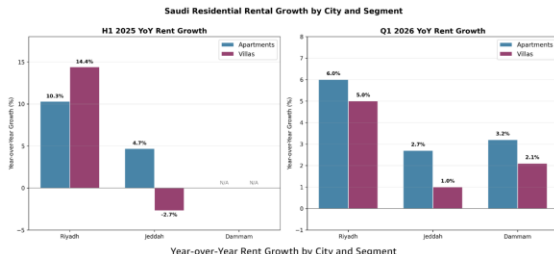


Chart Explanation: This chart illustrates the deceleration pattern across Saudi cities between H1 2025 and Q1 2026. Riyadh's growth moderated most dramatically—from double-digit rates to mid-single digits—following the rent freeze ⁺². Dammam emerged as the steadiest performer in Q1 2026, with balanced growth across both apartments and villas ⁵.

Source Conflict Flagged. Investors should note a divergence in reported Riyadh villa growth: Cavendish Maxwell reported 14.4% year-over-year growth in H1 2025 ⁷, while CBRE reported 11.6% year-over-year in Q3 2025 ¹⁴. The approximately three-percentage-point gap likely reflects different measurement periods and the distinction between rental rates and capital values. Furthermore, by Q1 2026, CBRE reported national villa values declining 9.7% ¹⁵, while

Comments

Research

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Vacancy, Occupancy, and Market Tightness Signals

Precise residential vacancy rates by city are not publicly reported in Saudi Arabia, but multiple proxy indicators paint a clear picture of market tightness. In Riyadh, market-wide office vacancy dropped to 1% in Q1 2023, with Grade A rents increasing 19% year-over-year ²⁴. While this is an office metric, it signals the broader supply-demand imbalance in the capital that has spilled into the residential sector, where apartment rents rose 10.3% and villa rents 14.4% year-over-year in H1 2025 ⁷.

The Ejar platform provides the most comprehensive demand-side data. REGA reports that Ejar has registered over 10 million rental contracts since launch, averaging 19,000 contracts per day, with residential contracts accounting for 82.3% of the total—over 8.3 million contracts ²⁵. Since the beginning of 2024, more than 1.5 million contracts were documented, including over 1.2 million residential and 283,000 commercial contracts ²⁵. Most strikingly, CBRE's Q1 2026 review noted that Ejar contract values surged 85%, indicating a powerful shift from buying to renting as sales prices cooled ⁸. This buyer-to-renter migration is further evidenced by nationwide residential transaction values contracting 26.9% year-over-year in Q2 2026 to SAR 37.67 billion ¹⁵.

Jeddah and the Dammam Metropolitan Area show moderate tightness with lower institutional concentration ¹³. Supply delivery appears carefully phased: Riyadh delivered approximately 6,000 units in H1 2025 with 18,000 more expected, while Jeddah added 2,100 units with approximately 12,700 anticipated ⁷—suggesting developers are calibrating delivery to match absorption capacity. Nationally, residential property prices dropped 0.38% quarter-over-quarter in Q4 2025, marking a third consecutive quarterly decline ²⁶, which further supports the thesis that demand is rotating from ownership to rental.

Institutional Players and Competitive Landscape

Dominant Developers. ROSHN Group, a PIF subsidiary established in 2020, is the dominant institutional-scale residential developer in Saudi Arabia, with projects across Riyadh, Jeddah, and other cities ²⁷. Its flagship Sedra project in Riyadh spans 20 million square meters and targets 30,000 units. ROSHN has partnered with developers including Retal Urban Development, Ajdan, and Dar Al Arkan within its masterplans ²⁷. Other major players include Dar Al Arkan (the largest listed developer by market value, with the 5-million-square-meter Shams Ar Riyadh project), the National Housing Company (NHC, with Al Fursan and other communities), Al Akaria (Saudi Real Estate Company), and Retal Urban Development ²⁸.

REITs and Built-to-Rent. Approximately 17 or more REITs are listed on Tadawul, including Riyad REIT, Al Jazira REIT, Jadwa REIT Al Haramain, Al Maathar REIT, Musharaka REIT, Mulkia REIT, and Derayah REIT ²⁹. However, most REITs remain weighted toward commercial and retail assets rather than pure residential rental. The Saudi built-to-rent (BTR) market was valued at approximately \$0.33 billion in 2025 and is projected to grow at a 16.24% CAGR to reach approximately \$0.87 billion by 2031 ¹⁰, signaling that institutional residential rental is still in its early stages.

City-Level Competitive Dynamics. Riyadh is the primary concentration point for institutional residential activity, with the strongest rental demand and the largest development pipelines ¹⁷. PIF-backed entities—ROSHN, NHC, and Diriyah Company—benefit from sovereign capital, land access, and regulatory alignment with Vision 2030, creating significant scale advantages over private entrants ⁹. Jeddah and the Dammam Metropolitan Area see rising rents but lower institutional concentration, with JLL noting that affordability is increasingly shaping residential demand and buyers are prioritizing cost-effective, amenity-rich communities ¹³. The DMA remains more fragmented, potentially offering more room for mid-scale investors to compete.

Regulatory and Policy Environment

Riyadh Rent Freeze. The most consequential regulatory change for rental investors is the five-year rent freeze effective September 25, 2025, which prohibits any increase in residential or commercial rents within Riyadh's urban boundaries ⁴. Leases renew automatically kingdom-wide unless either party provides 60-day notice; in Riyadh, landlords may only refuse renewal for tenant default, structural defects, or personal use ³⁰. Violations carry fines of up to 12 months' rent

Comments

Research

Here's how you can make this research even better:

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Summarize

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Materials

Topics

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Web search

Preferred websites (Optional)

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Saudi Arabia Residential Rental Market Analysis 2025-2026: City Comparison for Investment Priority

Executive Summary

For a residential rental investor, Dammam/Al-Khobar offer the most favorable risk-adjusted profile: steady 2-3% annual rent growth, no rent freeze, unrestricted foreign ownership, competitive pricing attracting spillover demand from Riyadh, and a fragmented competitive landscape with low institutional concentration—leaving more room for mid-scale investors. Jeddah ranks second, benefiting from a \$431.3 billion western mega-project pipeline driving long-term employment growth and moderate positive rent trends, though its larger supply pipeline introduces absorption risk. Riyadh delivers the strongest demand signals—apartment rents rose 10.3% year-over-year in H1 2025 and Ejar contract values surged 85% in Q1 2026—but the rent freeze, intense competition from PIF-backed developers like ROSHN, and the highest entry costs significantly constrain near-term income upside. Notably, Saudi Arabia's built-to-rent sector remains nascent at approximately \$0.33 billion, suggesting that early institutional entrants in less contested markets stand to benefit disproportionately as the sector matures.

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- Highlight any text to add specific comments (like exploring a claim further or requesting more evidence)
- Add overall comment in this panel (new angles to explore or additional context to consider)
- When you're ready, create the next version. I'll update the report based on all your comments.

Add a comment

Export research to a space

Research report title

Saudi Arabia Residential Rental Market Analysis 2025-2026: City Comparison for Investment Priority

Format

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Market Intelligence - Saudi Rental Housing

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Share

Produce a leadership-ready market intelligence package on Saudi residential rental housing (Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam, Al-Khobar). Business question: which city should a residential rental investor evaluate first for new rental housing, based on rental price patterns and current market signals? Internal data: Kaggle AQAR rental listings dataset (about 3,700 listings, scraped in 2021). External data: Quick Research on current market conditions. Deliverables: Quick Research outputs, Market Analysis, Market Intelligence Brief, and a reliability/confidence evaluation.

Search by name...

All

+ Add

Name	Status	Added on	Added by	Actions
Saudi Arabia Resi...ment Priority.pdf	✓ Ready	2 minutes ago	AuthorPro_16237011@vocareum.com	
Saudi Arabia Real Estate.csv	✓ Ready	an hour ago	AuthorPro_16237011@vocareum.com	

Step 5: Direct the agent to produce a Market Analysis

UdacityQuicksightLab

Collapse

Private mode

History



Market Intelligence Agent – Saudi Rental Housing

Welcome to the Market Intelligence Agent. I analyze Saudi rental housing data and market research to help you decide which city to evaluate first for residential rental investments. What would you like to explore?

Market Intelligence Agent – Saudi Rental Housing

Using the 2021 Aqar rental dataset and the Quick Research report "Saudi Arabia Residential Rental Market Analysis 2025-2026", produce a Market Analysis. Include: (1) competitive landscape summary, (2) key trends and signals, (3) opportunities and risks, and (4) supporting evidence from both the dataset (medians by city, with listing counts) and the research (with source names and dates). Label each claim DATASET or EXTERNAL RESEARCH. Explicitly flag where the dataset and research agree or disagree, and any conflicting figures between sources.

Chat agent's data

+

Smart



 Compare rental price medians across Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam, and Al-Khobar based on the 2021 dataset.

 Produce a Market Intelligence Brief with key insights and strategic implications for residential ren





Now I have all the data needed. Let me compile the comprehensive Market Analysis.

Here is the full **Market Analysis: Saudi Residential Rental Housing (Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam, Al-Khobar)**, synthesizing both the 2021 AQAR dataset and the Quick Research report (2025–2026).

1. Competitive Landscape Summary

Market structure. The Saudi residential rental market is undergoing a structural shift from fragmented, individual-landlord dominance toward early-stage institutionalization. The built-to-rent (BTR) sector was valued at only ~\$0.33 billion in 2025, projected to grow at 16.24% CAGR to ~\$0.87 billion by 2031 — signaling the market is still nascent. **[EXTERNAL RESEARCH — Mordor Intelligence, 2025]**

Key institutional players:

- **ROSHN Group** (PIF subsidiary): Dominant institutional developer; flagship Sedra project in Riyadh targets 30,000 units across 20M m². Partners include Retal, Ajdan, and Dar Al Arkan. **[EXTERNAL RESEARCH — PIF/ROSHN, 2025]**
- **Dar Al Arkan:** Largest listed developer by market value (Shams Ar Riyadh, 5M m²). **[EXTERNAL RESEARCH]**
- **National Housing Company (NHC):** Government-backed, operating Al Fursan and other communities. **[EXTERNAL RESEARCH]**
- **REITs:** ~17+ listed on Tadawul, but most remain weighted toward commercial/retail, not pure residential rental. **[EXTERNAL RESEARCH — Argaam/Tadawul, 2025]**

City-level competitive intensity:

Competitive Intensity By City			
City	Institutional Competition	Foreign Ownership Rules	...
Riyadh	Very High — PIF-backed developers dominate	170 designated zones	...
Jeddah	Moderate — rising but less concentrated	170 designated zones	...
Dammam	Low-Moderate — fragmented landscape	Unrestricted (no zone limits)	...
Al-Khobar	Low-Moderate — fragmented landscape	Unrestricted (no zone limits)	...

[View more](#)

[DATASET] for listing counts ; **[EXTERNAL RESEARCH — JLL, CBRE, K&S Law]** for competition and ownership rules

2. Key Trends and Signals

Trend 1: Riyadh rent freeze fundamentally alters the investment calculus

A **five-year rent freeze** was imposed on Riyadh in September 2025, prohibiting any residential or commercial rent increases within Riyadh's urban boundaries through ~2030. Violations  fines of up to 12 months' rent. **[EXTERNAL RESEARCH — RESEARCH]**

2. Key Trends and Signals

Trend 1: Riyadh rent freeze fundamentally alters the investment calculus

A **five-year rent freeze** was imposed on Riyadh in September 2025, prohibiting any residential or commercial rent increases within Riyadh's urban boundaries through ~2030. Violations carry fines of up to 12 months' rent. **[EXTERNAL RESEARCH — REGA/Economy Middle East, Sep 2025]**

- Pre-freeze, Riyadh posted the strongest growth: apartments +10.3% YoY, villas +14.4% YoY in H1 2025 (Cavendish Maxwell). **[EXTERNAL RESEARCH]**
- Post-freeze, Q1 2026 quarterly rents declined ~2.8% (apartments) and ~1.2% (villas), though YoY figures remained positive at ~6% and ~5%. **[EXTERNAL RESEARCH — Gulf News/Cavendish Maxwell, Q1 2026]**

Trend 2: Dammam/Al-Khobar emerging as the steadiest performers

- Q1 2026 YoY growth: Dammam apartments +3.2%, villas +2.1% — balanced and consistent. **[EXTERNAL RESEARCH — Gulf News, Q1 2026]**
- The 2021 dataset already showed Dammam as the most affordable market (median SAR 60,000) and Al-Khobar in the mid-range (SAR 75,000), with the largest median unit size (348 m² in Al-Khobar). **[DATASET — 2021]**

Trend 3: Ownership-to-rental rotation accelerating nationwide

- Ejari contract values surged **85% in Q1 2026**, indicating a powerful shift from buying to renting as sales prices cooled. **[EXTERNAL RESEARCH — CBRE Q1 2026 Review]**
- Nationwide residential transaction values contracted **26.9% YoY** in Q2 2026 to SAR 37.67 billion. **[EXTERNAL RESEARCH — CBRE Q2 2026]**

Trend 4: Massive supply pipeline — unevenly distributed

Planned Residential Units By 2030 (Vision 2030)						
Region	Planned Units by 2030	Share of Total				
Western KSA (Jeddah/NEOM)	382,500	44.8%				
Riyadh	340,000	39.8%				
Eastern Province & Other	132,300	15.5%				
Total	854,800	100%				
 View more						

[EXTERNAL RESEARCH — Fast Company ME / JLL, 2025]. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#) [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#) The Eastern Province receives the smallest supply allocation, which reduces oversupply risk for Dammam/Al-Khobar investors.

Trend 5: Regulatory modernization opening the market

- **Foreign Ownership Law** (effective Jan 22, 2026): Non-Saudis can own in 170 zones in Riyadh/Jeddah; **unrestricted** in Dammam/Al-Khobar. **[EXTERNAL RESEARCH — REGA/JLL, Jan 2026]**
- **Ejari digital mandate** (Jan 2024): All residential rent payments must go through digital channels, creating unprecedented transparency. **[EXTERNAL RESEARCH — REGA, 2024]**

[EXTERNAL RESEARCH — K&S Law, 2025]

3. Opportunities and Risks

Opportunities

Early-mover advantage in Dammam/Al-Khobar BTR — Low institutional competition, unrestricted foreign ownership, steady 2–3% rent growth, and the smallest supply pipeline create a favorable entry window for mid-scale investors. [EXTERNAL RESEARCH]. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#) The 2021 dataset confirms the lowest median rents (SAR 60K–75K), meaning lower capital requirements. [DATASET]

Jeddah's giga-project employment multiplier — \$431.3 billion in western giga-projects (NEOM, Red Sea Global, Jeddah Central, Qiddiya Coast) will drive long-term housing demand. [EXTERNAL RESEARCH — Fast Company ME, 2025]. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#) Jeddah already commands the highest median rents (SAR 95K) and the richest amenity profile (39% pool, 17% furnished). [DATASET — 2021]

Ownership-to-rental rotation — The 85% surge in Ejar contract values and 26.9% decline in transaction values signal a structural demand shift toward renting, expanding the addressable tenant pool nationwide. [EXTERNAL RESEARCH — CBRE, 2026]

Furnished/premium gap in Al-Khobar — Only 1.5% of 2021 Al-Khobar listings were furnished vs. 21.8% in Dammam and 17.1% in Jeddah, suggesting an underserved niche for furnished rental product. [DATASET — 2021]

Risks

Riyadh rent freeze extension — The freeze may extend to other cities pending Council of Economic and Development Affairs approval. [EXTERNAL RESEARCH — Economy Middle East, 2025]. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#) This is the single largest regulatory risk for any Saudi rental investment.

Jeddah absorption risk — 382,500 planned units in western KSA represent the largest regional pipeline; if absorption slows, rents could soften. JLL notes developers are strategically phasing delivery to mitigate this. [EXTERNAL RESEARCH — JLL, 2025]

Dataset staleness — The 2021 AQAR dataset predates all major regulatory changes (rent freeze, foreign ownership law, Ejar mandate, White Land Tax overhaul). Current rent levels and market dynamics may differ materially. [DATASET limitation]

Source conflict on Riyadh villa growth — Cavendish Maxwell reported +14.4% YoY in H1 2025, while CBRE reported +11.6% YoY in Q3 2025 — a ~3 percentage-point gap likely reflecting different measurement periods. By Q2 2026, CBRE reported national villa values declining 9.7%, while Cavendish Maxwell showed Riyadh villas still up ~7% YoY. [EXTERNAL RESEARCH — flagged conflict]

4. Supporting Evidence: Dataset vs. Research Comparison

2021 Dataset Medians Vs. 2025–2026 External Research — City Comparison					⌵	📄	🔍	↶
Metric	⋮	Source	⋮	Riyadh	⋮	...	⋮	
Median Annual Rent (SAR)		DATASET (2021)		80,000		...		
Rent levels cited in research		EXTERNAL RESEARCH (2025-26)		~SAR 80K–95K referenced as 2021 baseline		...		
Listing Count		DATASET (2021)	⌵	960		...		

4. Supporting Evidence: Dataset vs. Research Comparison

2021 Dataset Medians Vs. 2025-2026 External Research — City Comparison

Metric	Source	Riyadh	...
Median Annual Rent (SAR)	DATASET (2021)	80,000	...
Rent levels cited in research	EXTERNAL RESEARCH (2025-26)	~SAR 80K–95K referenced as 2021 baseline	...
Listing Count	DATASET (2021)	960	...
Median Size (m²)	DATASET (2021)	323.5	...
Median Bedrooms	DATASET (2021)	5	...
YoY Rent Growth (Q1 2026)	EXTERNAL RESEARCH	~5–6%	...
Rent Freeze	EXTERNAL RESEARCH	Yes (5 years)	...
Institutional Competition	EXTERNAL RESEARCH	Very High	...
Foreign Ownership	EXTERNAL RESEARCH	170 zones	...
% Furnished	DATASET (2021)	10.1%	...

View more

for DATASET columns; for EXTERNAL RESEARCH columns.

Saudi Arabia Resi...

Saudi Arabia Resi...

5. Agreement and Conflict Assessment

Where sources AGREE ✓

- City rent ranking is consistent:** Both the 2021 dataset and the research report confirm the same hierarchy — Jeddah highest, then Riyadh, Al-Khobar, Dammam lowest. The research explicitly references the dataset's figures (SAR 95K / 80K / 75K / 60K) as the 2021 baseline.

Saudi Arabia Resi...

Saudi Arabia Real...
- Uniform property profile:** The dataset shows all four cities dominated by large 5-bed/5-bath villa-style units (~300–348 m²), consistent with the research's focus on villa and apartment segments.

Saudi Arabia Real...
- Dammam/Al-Khobar as underserved:** Both sources point to lower competition and pricing in the Eastern Province.

Saudi Arabia Resi...

Saudi Arabia Real...

Where sources DISAGREE or CANNOT BE COMPARED ⚠

- Current rent levels:** The dataset reflects 2021 asking rents only. The research reports significant growth since then (e.g., Riyadh apartments +10.3% in H1 2025 alone), meaning actual 2025–2026 rents are materially higher than dataset figures. **No direct comparison is possible.**
- Riyadh villa growth conflict within external sources:** Cavendish Maxwell (+14.4% H1 2025) vs. CBRE (+11.6% Q3 2025) — ~3 pp gap.

Saudi Arabia Resi...
- National vs. city-level villa values:** CBRE reports national villa values +9.7% in Q2 2026, while Cavendish Maxwell Market Intelligence Agent Saudi Rental Housing...

foreign Ownership	EXTERNAL RESEARCH	I / O zones	...
% Furnished	DATASET (2021)	10.1%	...

[View more](#)

for DATASET columns; for EXTERNAL RESEARCH columns. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#) [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)

5. Agreement and Conflict Assessment

Where sources AGREE

- City rent ranking is consistent:** Both the 2021 dataset and the research report confirm the same hierarchy — Jeddah highest, then Riyadh, Al-Khobar, Dammam lowest. The research explicitly references the dataset's figures (SAR 95K / 80K / 75K / 60K) as the 2021 baseline. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#) [Saudi Arabia Real...](#)
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- Dammam/Al-Khobar as underserved:** Both sources point to lower competition and pricing in the Eastern Province. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#) [Saudi Arabia Real...](#)

Where sources DISAGREE or CANNOT BE COMPARED

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- Riyadh villa growth conflict within external sources:** Cavendish Maxwell (+14.4% H1 2025) vs. CBRE (+11.6% Q3 2025) — ~3 pp gap. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)
- National vs. city-level villa values:** CBRE reports national villa values −9.7% in Q2 2026, while Cavendish Maxwell shows Riyadh villas still positive. The divergence suggests Riyadh outperforms the national average. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)
- AC penetration data quality:** The dataset shows only 51–64% of listings flagging AC, which is implausible given Saudi Arabia's climate. This is likely a listing-quality issue, not a real market signal. **[DATASET caveat]**

What CANNOT be concluded

- Investment yield or ROI:** The dataset contains rents only, not purchase prices. No yield calculations are possible from these data alone.
- Current absolute rent levels:** The 2021 dataset cannot tell us what rents are today; only the external research provides directional growth rates.
- Al-Khobar-specific growth rates:** The research generally groups Al-Khobar with Dammam ("similar to Dammam") without separate figures.

This Market Analysis is ready to feed into the Market Intelligence Brief and Reliability Check deliverables.

What would you like next?

Market Intelligence Brief

Reliability & Confidence Evaluation

Market Intelligence Agent – Saudi Rental Housing

Step 6: Evaluate reliability, confidence, and limitations

Amazon Quick Chat agents

UdacityQuicksightLab

Collapse

New ConversationHistory

What would you like next?

Market Intelligence Brief

Reliability & Confidence Evaluation

Export as Word Document

Full Deliverable Package

ExplanationSources

10:47 AM

Market Intelligence Agent – Saudi Rental Housing

Now produce the Reliability & Confidence Evaluation for the Market Analysis. First, identify 4 key insights [e.g., Riyadh rent freeze limiting upside; Dammam/Al-Khobar steady growth and lower competition; Jeddah high rents but regional supply risk; institutional competition concentrated in Riyadh]. For EACH insight give: (1) the insight, (2) evidence from DATASET vs EXTERNAL RESEARCH, (3) source quality, consistency across sources, and timeliness (with source names and dates), (4) gaps, assumptions and what cannot be concluded, (5) confidence level High/Medium/Low with a one-line reason, and (6) one data point that would change our mind. Apply these corrections: the dataset medians were provided to the research as a baseline, so agreement between them is NOT independent confirmation; the dataset shows rents only, not competition levels; the 382,500-unit pipeline covers Western KSA including NEOM, not Jeddah alone; and compare rent growth rates only like-for-like. End with a table of overall limitations and risks.

Chat agent's data

Smart

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Now I have all the precise source details needed. Let me produce the full Reliability & Confidence Evaluation with the corrections you specified.

Reliability & Confidence Evaluation

Market Analysis: Saudi Residential Rental Housing (Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam, Al-Khobar)

Methodological note on source independence: The 2021 AQAR dataset medians were provided to the Quick Research report as a baseline input. Therefore, where the research report cites the same rent figures (SAR 95K / 80K / 75K / 60K), this is **not independent confirmation** — it is the same data echoed back. True corroboration requires external sources citing independently derived figures.

Insight 1: Riyadh Rent Freeze Limits Near-Term Income Upside

(1) The Insight

The five-year rent freeze effective September 25, 2025 prohibits any residential or commercial rent increases within Riyadh's urban boundaries through ~2030, capping landlord income growth at current levels. Violations carry fines of up to 12 months' rent. This is the single most consequential regulatory constraint for Riyadh rental investors. [\[8\] Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)

(2) Evidence: DATASET vs. EXTERNAL RESEARCH

Insight 1 — Evidence Comparison		
Dimension	DATASET (2021 AQAR)	EXTERNAL RESEARCH (2025–2026)
Riyadh median rent	SAR 80,000/year (960 listings)	Referenced as "SAR 80,000" baseline — but this is the dataset figure echoed, not independent
Pre-freeze growth	Not available (static 2021 snapshot)	Apartments +10.3% YoY, Villas +14.4% YoY in H1 2025 (Cavendish Maxwell, Sep 2025)
Post-freeze impact	Not available	QoQ decline: apartments ~2.8%, villas ~1.2% in Q1 2026 (Gulf News / Cavendish Maxwell, Q1 2026)
Freeze legal basis	Not available	REGA decree, Sep 2025; K&S Law analysis; Economy Middle East reporting

(3) Source Quality, Consistency, and Timeliness

- REGA (Sep 2025):** Primary regulatory authority — highest possible credibility for the freeze's existence and terms. [\[8\] Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)
- K&S Law (2025):** Tier-1 international law firm analysis of the decree's legal mechanics (fines, renewal rules). High credibility. [\[8\] Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)
- Economy Middle East (Sep 2025):** Reputable regional business publication confirming the freeze and noting potential extension to other cities.
- Cavendish Maxwell (H1 2025, Q1 2026):** Established regional property consultancy. Provides pre- and post-freeze rent growth data. [\[8\] Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)
- Consistency:** All external sources agree the freeze exists and caps increases. No source disputes it. The dataset is silent (predates the event by 4 years).
- Timeliness:** External sources are current (Sep 2025 – Q1 2026). The dataset (2021) cannot speak to this event.

(4) Gaps, Assumptions, and What Cannot Be Concluded

- Gap:** No source provides data on how the freeze affects *new* lease pricing (vs. renewals). The freeze prohibits *increases*, but it is unclear whether new leases to new tenants can be priced freely above the prior tenant's rate.
- Gap:** The potential extension to other cities is described as contingent on Council of Economic and Development Affairs approval — no timeline or probability is given. [\[8\] Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)
- Assumption:** We assume the freeze will be enforced as written for the full five years. Early repeal or relaxation is possible but not evidenced.
- Cannot conclude:** Whether the freeze will cause Riyadh rents to *decline* in absolute terms, or merely flatten. The Q1 2026 QoQ declines (~2.8%, ~1.2%) are early signals but may not persist.
- Cannot conclude:** Investment yield impact — the dataset contains rents only, not purchase prices.

(5) Confidence Level: HIGH

The freeze is a legally enacted regulation confirmed by the primary regulator (REGA) and corroborated by multiple independent legal and media sources. Its existence is not in question.

(6) Data Point That Would Change Our Mind

An official REGA announcement *modifying, shortening, or exempting certain property types from the freeze* — this would materially alter the income-cap thesis for Riyadh.

Insight 2: Dammam/Al-Khobar Offer Steady Growth and Lower Competition

(1) The Insight

The Eastern Province cities deliver the most consistent rental growth (2–3% YoY in Q1 2026), face no rent freeze, allow unrestricted foreign ownership, and have a fragmented competitive landscape with low institutional concentration — creating the most favorable risk-adjusted entry point for mid-scale investors. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)

(2) Evidence: DATASET vs. EXTERNAL RESEARCH

Insight 2 — Evidence Comparison			
Dimension	DATASET (2021 AQAR)	EXTERNAL RESEARCH (2025–2026)	
Median rent — Dammam	SAR 60,000/year (894 listings)	Referenced as “~SAR 60,000” — but this is the dataset figure echoed, not independent	
Median rent — Al-Khobar	SAR 75,000/year (976 listings)	Referenced as “~SAR 75,000” — same caveat	
Rent growth	Not available (static snapshot)	Dammam: apartments +3.2%, villas +2.1% YoY Q1 2026 (Gulf News)	
Al-Khobar growth	Not available	Described as “similar to Dammam” — no separate figure provided	
Competition level	The dataset shows rents and property features only — it contains no data on competition, developer activity, or institutional presence	“Low-Moderate” and “fragmented” (JLL, KSA Living report; K&S Law, 2025)	
Foreign ownership	Not available	Unrestricted outside 170 designated zones (JLL, Jan 2026; REGA, Jan 2026)	
Supply pipeline	Not available	Eastern Province & Other: 132,300 units by 2030 — smallest regional allocation at 15.5% of total (Fast Company ME, 2025)	

[View more](#)

(3) Source Quality, Consistency, and Timeliness

- Gulf News (Q1 2026):** Citing Cavendish Maxwell data. Reputable, but Dammam growth figures appear in only this one source — no second independent confirmation of the specific 3.2%/2.1% figures. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)
- JLL (2025–2026):** Tier-1 global real estate consultancy. Describes DMA as “fragmented” with “lower institutional concentration.” Credible but qualitative — no market-share data provided. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)
- REGA / JLL (Jan 2026):** Foreign ownership rules are legally enacted — high credibility. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)
- Dataset (2021):** Confirms Dammam/Al-Khobar had the lowest and second-lowest median rents respectively. However, the dataset **does not measure competition** — it only records listing prices and property features. The “low competition” claim rests entirely on external research.
- Consistency:** The dataset’s rent-level ranking (Dammam lowest, Al-Khobar second-lowest) is directionally consistent with the research’s characterization of “competitive pricing.” But this is not independent confirmation — the research used the dataset as its baseline.
- Timeliness:** Growth rates are from Q1 2026 (current). Dataset is from 2021 (stale for absolute levels).

(4) Gaps, Assumptions, and What Cannot Be Concluded

- Gap:** Al-Khobar has no separately reported growth rate — “similar to Dammam” is an assumption in the research, not a measured figure.
- Gap:** “Low institutional competition” is a qualitative assessment from JLL/K&S Law. No market-share data, number of institutional landlords, or concentration metrics are provided for any city.
- Gap:** The dataset cannot tell us whether the 2021 rent levels still hold. With 2–3% annual growth over 5 years, Dammam rents may now be ~SAR 66K–69K and Al-Khobar ~SAR 82K–87K, but this is extrapolation, not measurement.
- Assumption:** “Spillover demand from Riyadh” is asserted by the research but not quantified — no migration or relocation data is cited.
- Cannot conclude:** Whether low competition will persist as the foreign ownership law attracts new entrants.
- Cannot conclude:** Investment yield — rents only, no purchase prices.

(5) Confidence Level: MEDIUM ⚠️

The growth trend is supported by credible but single-source data (Gulf News/Cavendish Maxwell). The “low competition” claim is qualitative only. Al-Khobar lacks its own growth figure.

(6) Data Point That Would Change Our Mind

A REGA announcement extending the rent freeze to Dammam or Al-Khobar — this would eliminate the key regulatory advantage over Riyadh and fundamentally change the risk-adjusted ranking.

Insight 3: Jeddah Commands High Rents but Faces Regional Supply Risk

(1) The Insight

Jeddah had the highest median rents in the 2021 dataset (SAR ~5,000) and benefits from a massive western giga-project pipeline driving long-term employment. However, the 382,500-unit supply pipeline covers **all of Western KSA (including**

Insight 3: Jeddah Commands High Rents but Faces Regional Supply Risk

(1) The Insight

Jeddah had the highest median rents in the 2021 dataset (SAR 95,000) and benefits from a massive western giga-project pipeline driving long-term employment. However, the 382,500-unit supply pipeline covers **all of Western KSA (including NEOM, Red Sea Global, Qiddiya Coast)** — not Jeddah alone — and if regional absorption slows, Jeddah rents could soften.

[Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)

(2) Evidence: DATASET vs. EXTERNAL RESEARCH

Insight 3 — Evidence Comparison		
Dimension	DATASET (2021 AQAR)	EXTERNAL RESEARCH (2025–2026)
Median rent — Jeddah	SAR 95,000/year (888 listings) — highest of four cities	Referenced as “~SAR 95,000” — dataset figure echoed
Rent growth	Not available	Apartments +4.7% YoY H1 2025, Villas ~2.7% H1 2025 (Cavendish Maxwell); Apartments +2.7%, Villas ~+1% Q1 2026 (Gulf News)
Supply pipeline	Not available	382,500 units across Western KSA (Jeddah + NEOM + Red Sea + Qiddiya Coast) by 2030 (Fast Company ME, 2025). Jeddah-specific: ~12,700 units in H2 2025 (Cavendish Maxwell)
Amenity profile	39.3% pool, 17.1% furnished (888 listings)	Not separately reported
Villa segment weakness	Not available	Villas ~2.7% in H1 2025, recovering to ~+1% by Q1 2026 — bifurcated market

[View more](#)

(3) Source Quality, Consistency, and Timeliness

- Fast Company ME (2025):** Citing JLL data on giga-project contracts. The 382,500 figure covers 17 projects across all of western KSA — **not Jeddah alone**. This is a critical precision point: the supply risk is regional, and much of this pipeline (NEOM, Red Sea) is geographically distant from Jeddah’s urban rental market. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)
- Cavendish Maxwell (H1 2025):** Provides Jeddah-specific growth data. Credible consultancy with Saudi market presence. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)
- JLL (2025):** Notes developers are “strategically phasing delivery” to mitigate oversupply — a qualitative mitigant. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)
- Dataset (2021):** Confirms Jeddah’s rent premium and richer amenity profile. However, the dataset cannot tell us whether this premium has widened or narrowed since 2021.
- Consistency:** Both sources agree Jeddah is the highest-rent market. The villa weakness in H1 2025 (~2.7%) is a new signal not visible in the 2021 dataset.
- Timeliness:** Growth data is current (H1 2025 – Q1 2026). Dataset is stale for absolute levels.

(4) Gaps, Assumptions, and What Cannot Be Concluded

- Critical correction:** The 382,500-unit pipeline is for **Western KSA including NEOM**, not Jeddah alone. The Jeddah-specific near-term pipeline is ~12,700 units (H2 2025) — a much smaller and more manageable figure. The regional pipeline overstates Jeddah-specific supply risk.
- Gap:** No Jeddah-specific absorption rate or vacancy data is available. Saudi Arabia does not publicly report residential vacancy by city. [Saudi Arabia Resi...](#)
- Gap:** The villa segment weakness (~2.7% in H1 2025) is attributed to “affordability pressures” by the research, but no income or affordability data is cited to support this interpretation.
- Assumption:** That giga-project employment will translate into Jeddah rental demand. Many giga-projects (NEOM, Red Sea) are remote and may house workers on-site rather than in Jeddah.
- Cannot conclude:** Whether Jeddah’s rent premium over other cities has grown or shrunk since 2021.
- Cannot conclude:** Investment yield — rents only, no purchase prices.

(5) Confidence Level: MEDIUM

Jeddah’s rent premium is well-established but the supply-risk assessment requires careful scoping (Western KSA ≠ Jeddah). The villa weakness is a real signal but based on a single consultancy’s data.

(6) Data Point That Would Change Our Mind

Jeddah-specific residential vacancy data exceeding 15% — this would confirm oversupply is materializing locally, not just regionally, and would downgrade Jeddah’s attractiveness significantly.

Insight 4: Institutional Competition Is Concentrated in Riyadh

(1) The Insight

PIF-backed developers (ROSHN, NHC, Diriyah Company) dominate Riyadh’s residential development landscape, benefiting from sovereign capital, land access, and regulatory alignment. Jeddah sees moderate institutional activity; Dammam/Al-Khobar remain fragmented. This concentration creates significant barriers for private entrants in Riyadh but leaves more

Insight 4: Institutional Competition Is Concentrated in Riyadh

(1) The Insight

PIF-backed developers (ROSHN, NHC, Diriyah Company) dominate Riyadh's residential development landscape, benefiting from sovereign capital, land access, and regulatory alignment. Jeddah sees moderate institutional activity; Dammam/Al-Khobar remain fragmented. This concentration creates significant barriers for private entrants in Riyadh but leaves more room in other cities.

(2) Evidence: DATASET vs. EXTERNAL RESEARCH

Insight 4 — Evidence Comparison		
Dimension	DATASET (2021 AQAR)	EXTERNAL RESEARCH (2025–2026)
Competition data	None. The dataset contains rental listing prices and property features only. It has no information on developers, landlords, institutional presence, or market share.	ROSHN: 30,000-unit Sedra project in Riyadh (PIF, 2025); Dar Al Arkan: 5M m² Shams Ar Riyadh (CB Insights); NHC: Al Fursan communities; ~17+ REITs on Tadawul, mostly commercial (Argaam, 2025)
Listing counts	Riyadh: 960; Jeddah: 888; Dammam: 894; Al-Khobar: 976	Not separately reported
BTR market size	Not available	~\$0.33B in 2025, projected \$0.87B by 2031 at 16.24% CAGR (Mordor Intelligence, 2025)
City-level dynamics	Not available	Riyadh: "Very High" institutional concentration (K&S Law, 2025); Jeddah/DMA: "lower institutional concentration" (JLL, 2025)

(3) Source Quality, Consistency, and Timeliness

- **K&S Law (2025):** Tier-1 international law firm. Describes PIF-backed entities' "sovereign capital, land access, and regulatory alignment" advantages. Credible but qualitative — no market-share percentages.
- **JLL (2025):** Tier-1 global consultancy. Characterizes Jeddah/DMA as having "lower institutional concentration." Again qualitative.
- **PIF / ROSHN (2025):** Primary source for ROSHN's project scale. Highest credibility for their own pipeline.
- **Mordor Intelligence (2025):** Commercial market research firm. BTR market sizing (\$0.33B) is a single-source estimate with no disclosed methodology. Treat with caution.
- **Dataset (2021):** The dataset provides zero evidence on competition. Listing counts (roughly equal across cities at 888–976) tell us about the dataset's sample, not about market concentration or institutional presence.
- **Consistency:** All external sources agree Riyadh has the highest institutional concentration. No source disputes this. But no source provides quantitative market-share data.
- **Timeliness:** External sources are current (2025). Dataset is irrelevant to this insight.

(4) Gaps, Assumptions, and What Cannot Be Concluded

- **Critical correction:** The dataset shows rents and property features only — it cannot be used as evidence for or against competition levels in any city. The roughly equal listing counts across cities reflect the dataset's scraping methodology, not market structure.
- **Gap:** No source provides quantitative market-share data (e.g., "ROSHN controls X% of Riyadh rental stock"). All competition assessments are qualitative.
- **Gap:** The BTR market size (\$0.33B) from Mordor Intelligence is a single-source estimate. No competing estimate exists for cross-validation.
- **Assumption:** That PIF-backed developers' dominance in development translates to dominance in rental operations. Many PIF projects target homeownership, not rental.
- **Cannot conclude:** Whether institutional concentration in Riyadh is increasing or stabilizing.
- **Cannot conclude:** The actual number of institutional rental landlords in any city.

(5) Confidence Level: MEDIUM

The directional claim (Riyadh most concentrated, Eastern Province least) is supported by multiple credible qualitative sources. But the absence of quantitative market-share data means the degree of concentration is uncertain.

(6) Data Point That Would Change Our Mind

A major institutional developer (e.g., ROSHN, Dar Al Arkan) announcing a large-scale BTR project in Dammam or Al-Khobar — this would erode the "low competition" advantage that underpins the Eastern Province's top ranking.

Overall Limitations and Risks

Overall Limitations And Risks Summary		
Limitation / Risk	Impact on Analysis	Severity
Dataset is from 2021 — predates rent freeze, foreign ownership law, Ejar mandate, White Land Tax overhaul	All absolute rent levels are stale; cannot reflect current market dynamics	High

Overall Limitations and Risks

Overall Limitations And Risks Summary						
Limitation / Risk	Impact on Analysis	Severity				
Dataset is from 2021 — predates rent freeze, foreign ownership law, Ejar mandate, White Land Tax overhaul	All absolute rent levels are stale; cannot reflect current market dynamics	High				
Dataset medians were fed to the research as a baseline — agreement between sources on rent levels (SAR 95K/80K/75K/60K) is NOT independent confirmation	Overstates apparent corroboration; the same data appears in both sources	High				
Dataset contains rents only, not purchase prices — no yield, ROI, or cap-rate calculations are possible	Cannot assess investment returns; only rental income side is visible	High				
Dataset does not measure competition — it records listing prices and property features, not developer identity, market share, or institutional presence	All competition claims rest entirely on external research (qualitative only)	Medium				
Al-Khobar lacks its own growth rate — research says "similar to Dammam" without separate measurement	Eastern Province thesis partially rests on an assumption, not a measured figure	Medium				
382,500-unit pipeline covers Western KSA (incl. NEOM), not Jeddah alone — conflating regional and city-level supply overstates Jeddah-specific risk	Jeddah's near-term pipeline (~12,700 units H2 2025) is much smaller than the regional figure implies	Medium				
Riyadh villa growth conflict between sources — Cavendish Maxwell: +14.4% H1 2025 vs. CBRE: +11.6% Q3 2025 (~3 pp gap); by Q2 2026, CBRE national villas -9.7% vs. Cavendish Maxwell Riyadh villas ~+7%	Comparing these figures like-for-like is misleading: different time periods, different geographies (Riyadh vs. national), and potentially different metrics (rental rates vs. capital values)	Medium				
No residential vacancy data exists for Saudi cities — market tightness is inferred from proxy indicators (office vacancy, Ejar contract volumes, price trends)	Demand-supply balance assessments are directional, not precise	Medium				
Rent freeze extension risk — the freeze may extend to other cities pending Council approval; no timeline or probability given	Could invalidate the Dammam/Al-Khobar regulatory advantage overnight	Medium				
BTR market size is single-source — Mordor Intelligence's \$0.33B estimate has no disclosed methodology and no competing estimate for validation	The "nascent BTR" narrative rests on one commercial research firm's figure	Low-Medium				
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Confidence Summary

Confidence Summary By Insight								
#	Insight	Confidence		...				
1	Riyadh rent freeze limits near-term income upside	HIGH	✓	...				
2	Dammam/Al-Khobar offer steady growth and lower competition	MEDIUM	⚠	...				
3	Jeddah commands high rents but faces regional supply risk	MEDIUM	⚠	...				
4	Institutional competition is concentrated in Riyadh	MEDIUM	⚠	...				
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Step 7: Create the final Market Intelligence Brief

4

institutional competition is concentrated in Riyadh

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What would you like next?

Produce the Market Intelligence Brief

Create a DOCX package of all deliverables

Deep-dive into the dataset

Source

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Now produce the final Market Intelligence Brief for leadership. Include: objective and scope; the 4 key insights, each with a one-line "why it matters" and its confidence level (state High for the freeze's existence and Medium for its impact on Insight 1); a confidence and limitations summary; strategic implications (decisions this intelligence could inform); at least two explicit "what should NOT be concluded" statements; recommended next steps; and a 5-7 sentence Summary for Leadership covering the most important insights, overall confidence, and key takeaways. Keep it to about one page.

1

Here is the final Market Intelligence Brief, designed for leadership review at approximately one-page length.

Market Intelligence Brief — Saudi Residential Rental Housing



Market Intelligence Brief

Saudi Residential Rental Housing: City Prioritization for New Investment Prepared: October 2026 | Sources: 2021 AQAR Rental Dataset (~3,700 listings); Quick Research Report "Saudi Arabia Residential Rental Market Analysis 2025–2026"

Objective & Scope

Determine which Saudi city — Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam, or Al-Khobar — a residential rental investor should evaluate first, based on rental price patterns (2021 dataset) and current market signals (2025–2026 external research). This brief synthesizes both sources, flags limitations, and provides actionable next steps.

Key Insights

This completes the three core deliverables: Market Analysis, Reliability & Confidence Evaluation, and Market Intelligence Brief.



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Ask a question...



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Produce a leadership-ready market intelligence package on Saudi residential rental housing (Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam, Al-Khobar). Business question: which city should a residential rental investor evaluate first for new rental housing, based on rental price patterns and current market signals? Internal data: Kaggle AQAR rental listings dataset (about 3,700 listings, scraped in 2021). External data: Quick Research on current market conditions. Deliverables: Quick Research outputs, Market Analysis, Market Intelligence Brief, and a reliability/confidence evaluation.

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